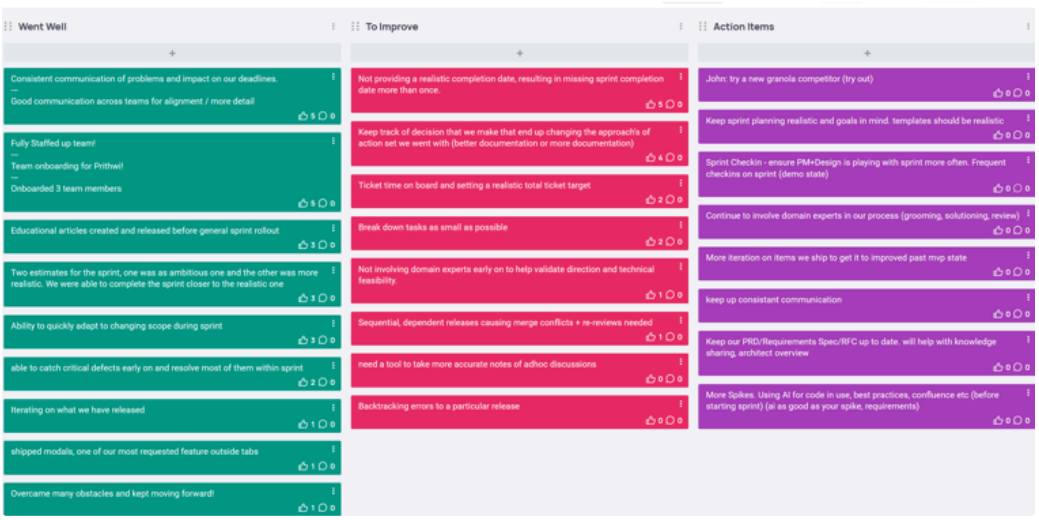
Sprint Retro - Sept 9th 2025



Sprint Overview

This retrospective was conducted for the Sales Management team following the completion of Sprint 1, which focused on the Inventory Creation Modal feature. The team gathered to reflect on the sprint's successes, challenges, and identify actionable improvements for future iterations.

What Went Well 🎯

The team successfully demonstrated strong collaboration and adaptability throughout the sprint:

- **Effective Communication**: The team maintained consistent communication about problems and their impact on deadlines, ensuring transparency across all team members with detailed alignment discussions
- **Successful Onboarding**: Fully staffed up the team with successful onboarding 3 additional team members
- **Knowledge Sharing**: Educational articles were created and released before the general sprint rollout, facilitating knowledge transfer
- **Sprint Estimation Balance**: The team worked with two estimates - one ambitious and one realistic - and successfully completed the sprint closer to the realistic timeline
- **Adaptability**: Demonstrated strong ability to quickly adapt to changing scope during the sprint
- **Quality Focus**: Successfully caught critical defects early and resolved most issues within the sprint

- **Feature Delivery**: Shipped modals, including one of the most requested features for outside tabs
- **Resilience**: Overcame numerous obstacles while maintaining forward momentum

Areas for Improvement 🔧

Several key areas were identified where the team can enhance their processes:

- **Sprint Planning**: Not providing a realistic completion date resulted in missing the initial sprint completion target
- **Decision Making**: Need to track decisions more effectively and involve the right stakeholders earlier (better documentation or more documentation needed)
- **Ticket Management**: Ticket time on board and setting realistic total ticket targets need improvement
- **Task Breakdown**: Breaking down tasks as small as possible for better manageability
- **Domain Expert Involvement**: Not involving domain experts early enough to help validate direction and technical feasibility
- **Release Management**: Sequential, dependent releases caused merge conflicts and increased re-review needs
- **Documentation**: Need better tools for taking accurate notes during ad-hoc discussions
- **Backtracking Issues**: Errors in backtracking to particular releases caused delays

Action Items 📋

The team committed to the following action items to address the identified improvement areas:

1. **Tooling Enhancement**: John to try out a new Granola competitor for better meeting note-taking
2. **Sprint Planning Improvements**: Keep sprint planning realistic with goals in mind; templates should be realistic
3. **Sprint Check-ins**: Ensure PM+Design is playing with sprint more often, with frequent check-ins on sprint progress (demo state)
4. **Domain Expert Engagement**: Continue to involve domain experts in the process early (grooming, solutioning, review)
5. **MVP State Iteration**: More iteration on items shipped to get them to improved post-MVP state
6. **Communication**: Keep up consistent communication practices established this sprint
7. **Documentation Standards**: Keep PRD/Requirements Spec/RFC up to date to help with knowledge sharing and architect overview

8. **AI Integration**: Explore using AI for code in use, best practices, and Confluence documentation (before starting sprint) as a good practice aligned with spike requirements

Key Takeaways

This sprint demonstrated the team's strong ability to deliver value while adapting to challenges. The focus on communication and quality helped deliver critical features, including highly requested functionality. Moving forward, the emphasis will be on more realistic planning, earlier stakeholder involvement, and improved documentation practices to maintain momentum while reducing friction in the development process.